LIBRARY OF FAITH

The Apostles' Creed

The early church — Western baptismal confession

TRADITION
Early church

DATES
Roots in the 2nd century; received form by about the 8th century

LENGTH
1 short page · Very easy

WHY READ IT
The church's oldest short summary of the faith — a baptismal confession that walks through the whole gospel in a dozen lines, from creation to the life everlasting. Christians have learned it by heart for well over a thousand years.

BEST PLACE TO START
Read it straight through — it takes a minute. Then read it again slowly, one article at a time.

SOURCE
Philip Schaff, Creeds of Christendom, with a History and Critical Notes, Vol. II (New York: Harper & Brothers, 1877). Text via the Christian Classics Ethereal Library (CCEL).

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The Creed

The Creed

I believe in God the Father Almighty, Maker of heaven and earth.

And in Jesus Christ, his only Son, our Lord; who was conceived by the Holy Ghost, born of the Virgin Mary; suffered under Pontius Pilate, was crucified, dead, and buried; he descended into hell; the third day he rose from the dead; he ascended into heaven, and sitteth at the right hand of God the Father Almighty; from thence he shall come to judge the quick and the dead.

I believe in the Holy Ghost; the holy catholic Church; the communion of saints; the forgiveness of sins; the resurrection of the body; and the life everlasting. Amen.